LN LIBRARY v1.0 — Installation Guide

How to install it, where everything goes, how to use it and what is new (October 2026 edition)

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What LN Library is

LN ("Library New") is a library for C# programmers: a set of ready-to-use methods for dates, times, validations (for example a vehicle VIN number), text strings, sending e-mail and on-screen messages. It is not a program you open with a double click: it is added as a reference to a Visual Studio project. Each method is explained in the **"Class LN v1.0"** manual; this guide explains how to install it, where everything goes and how to add it to a project.

Requirements

- Windows 10 or Windows 11.
- Visual Studio 2022 (version 17.8 or later) or Visual Studio 2026, with the .NET 8 SDK or later.
- A Windows project targeting `net8.0-windows` or later with Windows Forms enabled (`<UseWindowsForms>true</UseWindowsForms>`), because LN uses Windows Forms message windows.
- About 2 MB of free disk space.

Where to download it

The installer is available in Spanish (`SetupLN-es.msi`), in English (`SetupLN-en.msi`) and in a multilingual version (`SetupLN-all.msi`). It is downloaded from:

> https://github.com/HectorFortun2024/LN-Library/releases/latest

How to install it

1. Double-click the installer you chose (for example, `SetupLN-en.msi`).
2. If the blue window **"Windows protected your PC"** appears, click **"More info"** and then **"Run anyway"** (the reason is explained in the box below).
3. If Windows asks **"Do you want to allow this app to make changes to your device?"** (Publisher: Unknown), click **"Yes"**.
4. Follow the wizard: accept the license, keep the proposed folder and click **"Install"**.
5. When it finishes, click **"Finish"**.

> **Why does Windows show a warning?**
> LN is free and the installer has no digital signature (a code-signing certificate costs money every year). Windows warns about any unsigned program downloaded from the Internet, even if it is safe. Install it only if you downloaded it from the official link above.

Where everything goes

What	Where
Library	`C:\Program Files (x86)\Hector Fortun\LN Library\LN.dll` (with `LN.deps.json` and `LN.pdb`) **LN.dll** is also copied to the Desktop, to keep it handy.
Manuals (PDF)	**Class LN v1.0.pdf** (English) and **Clase LN v1.0.pdf** (Spanish) In the library folder and on the Desktop. Start menu › **LN Library** folder › Clase LN v1.0 / Class LN v1.0.
License	Shown in full during installation (MIT license).
Source code	https://github.com/HectorFortun2024/LN-Library

How to use it in a project

1. In Visual Studio, open (or create) a Windows project for .NET 8 or later, for example a **Windows Forms App**.
2. In **Solution Explorer**, right-click **Dependencies › Add Project Reference…**, click **"Browse…"** and choose `LN.dll` (from the library folder or from the Desktop).
3. Create an LN object and call its methods:

```
LN.LN ln = new LN.LN();
bool valid = ln.VINCheck("1HGCM82633A004352");
```

How to uninstall it

1. Open **Settings › Apps › Installed apps** (or Control Panel › Programs and Features).
2. Find **LN Library**, click **"Uninstall"** and confirm.

The library, the manuals and the Desktop copies are removed. Projects that already use LN keep their own copy of `LN.dll` in their `bin` folder.

What is new in this edition

- The methods that extract or convert dates and times now work on Windows in Spanish (they used to fail on computers with Spain or Mexico regional settings).
- `VINCheck` checks the 17 characters of the VIN and rejects the letters I, O and Q (it used to fail with short VINs).
- `FindStr` and `DeleteSTR` search for the text as is (a dot or a parenthesis used to be taken as a regular expression).
- The alphabetic and alphanumeric validators no longer accept commas; `DeleteChar` deletes by characters.
- It uses .NET's own Windows Forms: the installer no longer copies Windows libraries.
- New icon and MIT license: LN is free and open source.

License

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